

The Federal + State Rebate Stacker Checklist

Exactly which US clean-energy credits and rebates stack on top of each other — and the ones that quietly cancel each other out. Print it, tick the boxes, and don't leave money on the table.

How stacking works in 30 seconds. Federal tax credits, state programs, and utility rebates are usually separate pots of money. Most *stack* — you can claim several on one project. A few *collide* — claiming one disqualifies another, or one reduces the dollar basis of another. This sheet shows you both, program by program, for the 2026 tax year.

1 • The eight federal incentives at a glance

Code	Program	What it covers	Max value	Through
25C	Energy Efficient Home Improvement	Heat pumps, insulation, windows, doors, AC, panels, audits	\$3,200 / yr	2032
25D	Residential Clean Energy	Solar, battery storage, geothermal, solar water heating	30%, no cap	2034
30C	EV Charger (Refueling Property)	Home EV charger + tied electrical work	\$1,000	2032
30D	New Clean Vehicle	Qualifying new EV purchase/lease	\$7,500	2032
25E	Previously-Owned Clean Vehicle	Qualifying used EV from a registered dealer	\$4,000	2032
HEEHRA	High-Efficiency Electric Home Rebate	Point-of-sale rebates, income-qualified households	\$14,000	2031*
HOMES	Home Energy Savings Rebate	Whole-home retrofit by modelled/measured savings	\$8,000	2031*
45L	New Energy Efficient Home (builder)	Builder credit on ENERGY STAR / ZERH new homes	\$5,000	2032

* HEEHRA & HOMES run until 2031 *or until your state's allocation runs out* — these are first-come, first-served. Reserve early.

2 • The stacking matrix — what plays nicely

If you're claiming...	Stacks with	Does NOT stack with
25C heat pump / efficiency	State + utility rebates · HOMES · 25D · 30C	HEEHRA on the same item
25D solar / battery	State + utility rebates · SRECs · 25C · 30D	Commercial Sec. 48 ITC on same gear
30C EV charger	State + utility charger rebates · 30D · 25E	— (watch census-tract rule)
30D new EV	State EV rebates · utility TOU rebates · 30C	25E (used) · commercial 45W on same car
25E used EV	State used-EV rebates · 30C charger	30D — used EVs use 25E, not 30D
HEEHRA rebate	State + utility rebates	25C on the same item — pick the bigger
HOMES retrofit	25C (best pairing) · state + utility rebates	HEEHRA on the same measure
45L builder	Buyer's 25D · 25C · 30D — all independent	—

⚠ The four traps that cost people the most

- **25C vs HEEHRA on the same equipment.** You can't claim both on one heat pump. HEEHRA wins for income-qualified households; 25C wins for higher earners. Run the numbers before the installer applies anything.

- **State/utility rebates reduce your federal 25C/25D basis.** The federal credit is 30% of cost *minus* rebates received. Stacking still wins almost every time — but your 30% is calculated on the lower number, so don't double-count.
- **Used EV = 25E only.** A used EV never qualifies for the \$7,500 30D. Claiming the wrong one triggers an IRS rejection.
- **30C census tract.** The home-charger credit only applies in eligible census tracts. Check the DOE Argonne lookup *before* you install and screenshot the result with the date.

3 • Claim checklist — tick as you go

25C • HEAT PUMP & EFFICIENCY

Up to \$3,200 every year

- ☐ Get written confirmation the equipment meets the required CEE tier (save model + PINs)
- ☐ Keep itemised receipts separating equipment, labour and any rebates
- ☐ File IRS Form 5695 Part II with your return
- ☐ Spread big projects across two tax years — the cap resets each January
- ☐ Keep records for at least 3 years

25D • SOLAR & BATTERY

30% of cost, no cap

- ☐ Confirm you *own* the system (leases & PPAs don't qualify)
- ☐ Document total cost: equipment, labour, permitting, interconnection
- ☐ File IRS Form 5695 Part I
- ☐ Carry any unused credit forward to next year
- ☐ Record the credit amount for your cost basis at sale

30C / 30D / 25E • EV & CHARGER

Up to \$7,500 + \$1,000

- ☐ New EV: confirm eligibility & credit on fueleconomy.gov by VIN date
- ☐ Check the MAGI income cap (use the lower of two tax years)
- ☐ Decide point-of-sale transfer vs claim-at-filing (math is identical)
- ☐ Used EV: confirm the dealer is IRS-registered, then use 25E (not 30D)
- ☐ Charger: verify census tract, then file Form 8911

HEEHRA / HOMES • STATE REBATES

Up to \$14,000 per household

- ☐ Check your state portal's launch status & remaining allocation
- ☐ Verify income vs Area Median Income (AMI)
- ☐ Reserve the rebate *before* installation (first-come, first-served)
- ☐ Use a state-certified contractor — they handle the paperwork
- ☐ Confirm the discount shows as a line item on your invoice

4 • The highest-value legal stacks

Project	Stack it like this	Combined ceiling
Whole-home retrofit	HOMES + 25C + state/utility rebates	\$8,000 + \$3,200/yr
Heat pump (income-qualified)	HEEHRA + state/utility rebates (not 25C on same unit)	up to \$14,000
Solar + battery	25D + state programme + utility rebate + SRECs	30% + state \$
New EV + home charger	30D + 30C + state EV rebate + utility TOU rebate	\$8,500 + state \$
New ENERGY STAR home	Builder 45L behind the scenes + your 25D / 25C / 30D	stacks fully

Find every rebate for your state

Your state and utility add the biggest dollars on top of these federal credits. Look up your exact programs, eligibility and deadlines at claimwatt.com — search by state, technology or city.

ClaimWatt • claimwatt.com — Independent guide to US clean-energy rebates and tax credits. This checklist is general information for the 2026 tax year, not tax, legal or financial advice. Program rules, caps and deadlines change; always confirm current details with the IRS, your state energy office and a qualified tax professional before filing. ClaimWatt may earn affiliate commissions from partners linked on the site.